

Speaking Performance Standards

Categories	Factors
1. Content/Coherence	✓ Number of ideas ✓ Quality of ideas ✓ Organization of ideas ✓ Examples and supporting details
2. Vocabulary	✓ Word choice ✓ Suitable use of words and phrases ✓ Range of words and phrases ✓ Precision and accuracy
3. Listenability	✓ Rhythm, pronunciation, and intonation ✓ Pauses, interjections, and self-correction ✓ Grammar and sentence structure ✓ Variety of sentence structure
4. Task Fulfillment	✓ Relevance ✓ Completeness ✓ Tone ✓ Length

1. Content/Coherence

This category measures how smoothly and effectively the ideas flow together to form a meaningful and coherent whole.

- Are there enough ideas, and have they been explained clearly?
- Are the ideas well organized so that the listener can easily follow what is being said?
- Can the test taker express precise meaning and/or explore deeper levels of meaning?

2. Vocabulary

This category assesses how well the test taker uses vocabulary, idioms, and phrases to make their ideas understandable.

- Is the range of words sufficient to complete the task?
- How well is the test taker using words that help express precise ideas clearly with minimal pausing and hesitation?

- Can the test taker combine words to express precise meaning?
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3. Listenability

This category measures how intelligible and fluent your speaking is.

- How much do problems with rhythm, pronunciation, and intonation interfere with listenability?
 - How fluent is the response (listen for hesitations, interjections, and/or self-correction)?
 - Does the test taker's control of grammar and syntax interfere with or improve listenability?
 - Is there complexity and variety in the sentence structure?
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4. Task Fulfillment

This category considers how well the content of the response addresses the task requirements. In other words, has the test taker understood the instructions and done everything he was asked to do?

- How well does the response address the task?
- How complete is the response?
- Is the tone of the response appropriate for the social context of the task?
- Is the response long enough?